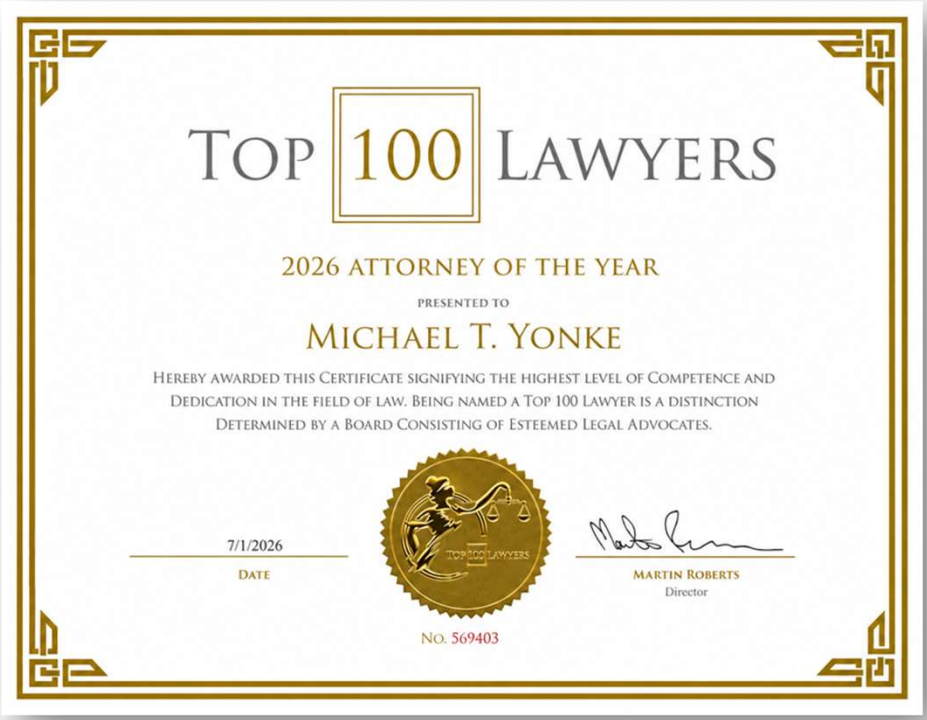

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Michael T. Yonke Featured in Top 100 Lawyers Magazine
Yonke Law founding attorney Michael T. Yonke has been featured in the Spring 2026 edition of Top 100 Lawyers, a national publication profiling distinguished attorneys across the United States.
The feature traces Mike's path from the University of Missouri–Columbia, where he earned his Bachelor of Arts in political science and psychology in 1990, through the University of Missouri–Kansas City School of Law, where he was a member of the National Trial Advocacy Team. It follows his early courtroom experience at the Jackson County Prosecutor's Office — including work on first-degree murder and sexual assault prosecutions — through his time at his father's law firm and the founding of Yonke Law, LLC.
Practice and Recognition
TOP 100 LAWYERS
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MICHAEL T. YONKE
TOP 100 LAWYERS
Michael T. Yonke
Michael T. Yonke is a distinguished trial attorney and founding partner of Yonke Law, LLC, one of Kansas City's leading law firms. Known for his dedication to justice and unwavering advocacy, Mr. Yonke specializes in personal injury and medical malpractice law, where he has built a reputation for achieving successful outcomes on behalf of his clients. His career reflects not only professional skill but also a lifelong commitment to helping those in need.

Featured in the Spring 2026 edition of Top 100 Lawyers



TOP 100 LAWYERS

Michael T. Yonke

Michael T. Yonke is a distinguished trial attorney and founding partner of Yonke Law, LLC, one of Kansas City's leading law firms. Known for his dedication to justice and unwavering advocacy, Mr. Yonke specializes in personal injury and medical malpractice law, where he has built a reputation for achieving successful outcomes on behalf of his clients. His career reflects not only professional skill but also a lifelong commitment to helping those in need.

Mr. Yonke's path to law was shaped by his dual interests in political science and psychology, which he studied at the University of Missouri–Columbia, earning a Bachelor of Arts in 1990. He went on to obtain his Juris Doctor from the University of Missouri–Kansas City School of Law, where he distinguished himself as a member of the National Trial Advocacy Team. During this time, he gained early courtroom experience through an internship at the Jackson County Prosecutor's Office, where he assisted on serious cases, including first-degree murder and sexual assault prosecutions. These experiences honed his trial skills and fueled his passion for litigation.

Following graduation, Mr. Yonke began his legal career at his father's law firm, where he developed a strong foundation in trial practice before establishing Yonke Law, LLC. His firm quickly grew into a respected name in the region, representing clients in high-stakes cases with compassion and determination. Licensed to practice before the U.S. District Court for the District of Kansas and the U.S. District Court for the Western District of Missouri, he continues to champion the rights of individuals against powerful institutions. In addition to his practice, Mr. Yonke has made significant contributions to the legal community. He is an active member of the American Association for Justice, the Missouri Association of Trial Attorneys. He has served as the Board of Governors of the Missouri Association of Trial Attorneys. Mr. Yonke has shared his expertise as a lecturer on medical malpractice for the Kansas City Metropolitan Bar Association and has published legal scholarship, including the article "High Stacked Merchandise – A Hazard in the Courtroom" in 2006. His leadership extends beyond the courtroom into philanthropy, as the founder of the Derick Thomas Neil Smith Law Foundation, which supports local youth and promotes opportunities for the next generation.

Mr. Yonke's excellence has been recognized with numerous accolades. He has been named to the Best of the Bar by the Kansas City Business Journal, and consistently honored as a Missouri & Kansas Super Lawyer. He also holds the prestigious AV Preeminent Peer Review Rating from Martindale-Hubbell, a mark of the highest level of professional integrity and legal ability. Despite his demanding career, Mr. Yonke values community and family. Outside of his legal practice, he dedicates time to coaching basketball, a role that allows him to inspire and mentor young athletes. For Mr. Yonke, success is defined not only by courtroom victories but also by his ability to give back—to his clients, his community, and the youth whose futures he helps to shape.



The Avvo Rating is an independent, data-driven measure of an attorney's professional background and standing. Attorneys are rated on a 1–10 scale using a mathematical model that considers factors legal consumers value, including professional experience, industry recognition, and disciplinary history. The rating is applied consistently across attorneys regardless of firm size and **cannot be purchased**. A top Avvo Rating provides clients with an easy-to-understand, third-party measure of an attorney's experience, reputation, and professional standing.



Kansas City Business Journal — Best of the Bar

The Kansas City Business Journal's Best of the Bar recognizes accomplished attorneys who have distinguished themselves within the Kansas City legal community. Eligible attorneys must have at least 10 years of professional practice and be engaged in private practice in the Kansas City metropolitan area. Nominees are evaluated by a panel of judges from the legal profession based on **professional reputation, involvement in significant cases or transactions, and civic involvement**. Selection recognizes attorneys whose impact extends beyond individual results to include their standing within the profession and contributions to the broader community.



Best Law Firms recognizes law firms for professional excellence and distinguished performance within specific areas of legal practice. The recognition builds upon the peer-review principles of Best Lawyers, evaluating the reputation and capabilities of a firm within its market and practice areas. Recognition represents more than the accomplishments of a single attorney—it reflects the collective strength, experience, and quality of legal services delivered by the firm.



Best Lawyers is a peer-selected recognition of individual attorneys for excellence in the practice of law. Recognition is based entirely on peer review, capturing the consensus of leading attorneys practicing in the same geographic region and area of law. Attorneys evaluate their colleagues based on a defining question: *If you were unable to take a case yourself, how likely would you be to refer it to this attorney?* Candidates are rated, evaluated by the Best Lawyers research team, and verified to be in good standing before recognition is awarded.



Lawyers of Distinction (LOD) is an attorney-selected organization recognizing excellence in the practice of law across approximately 30 areas of practice. Recognition spans a broad range of legal disciplines, including civil litigation, criminal defense, corporate and transactional law, family law, medical malpractice, personal injury, real estate, estate planning and trusts, workers' compensation, and many others. LOD recognition reflects professional distinction within the legal community and acknowledges attorneys for their accomplishments and excellence in their respective areas of practice.